REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE V

Opponents call Measure V's tax increase drastic. It adds one cent per dollar - 8.125% to 9.125% - and groceries and prescription medicine remain exempt.

The real driver of City's shortfall is costs, not overspending. Vacaville's largest revenue source, sales tax, is projected to fall nearly **$10 million,** while equipment costs climb - police vehicles up **56.6%,** fire engines up **71.4%.** The City already cut **$9 million** through a 2.5% City-wide reduction, frozen hiring, and reduced programs. Even so, the annual gap approaches $12 million.

Left unaddressed, further cuts hit residents directly: slower 911 dispatch and police response, fewer fire and paramedic units, deferred street repairs, and neglected parks.

This is not a passing dip. The City's budget identifies a structural deficit - costs outpacing revenue - persisting for years without new, dedicated funding.

Reserves won't fill the gap: the **Reserve Policy** limits reserves to one-time and emergency needs, not ongoing shortfalls, and without new revenue, reserves are forecasted to be **depleted by 2030.**

Opponents cite the City's **$39.4 million** pension obligation to suggest Measure V revenue will vanish into pension debt. That's misleading: pension costs are an existing, budgeted obligation that the City must pay regardless of Measure V. The City has already curbed future pensions costs by moving new hires into a lower-cost plan, reducing future costs. Measure V maintains police, fire, 911 response, roads, and parks - it will not create a new pension obligation.

Vote YES on Measure V to protect the services Vacaville families rely on.

/s/ Daniel Marshall, Vacaville Resident/Fairfield Chief of Police

/s/ Matthew Thomas, Police Captain (retired}

/s/ Doug Beaumont, Vacaville Resident

/s/ Matt Moreno, Vacaville Firefighters Association - President

/s/ Sean Kelly, Vacaville Police Officers' Association - President